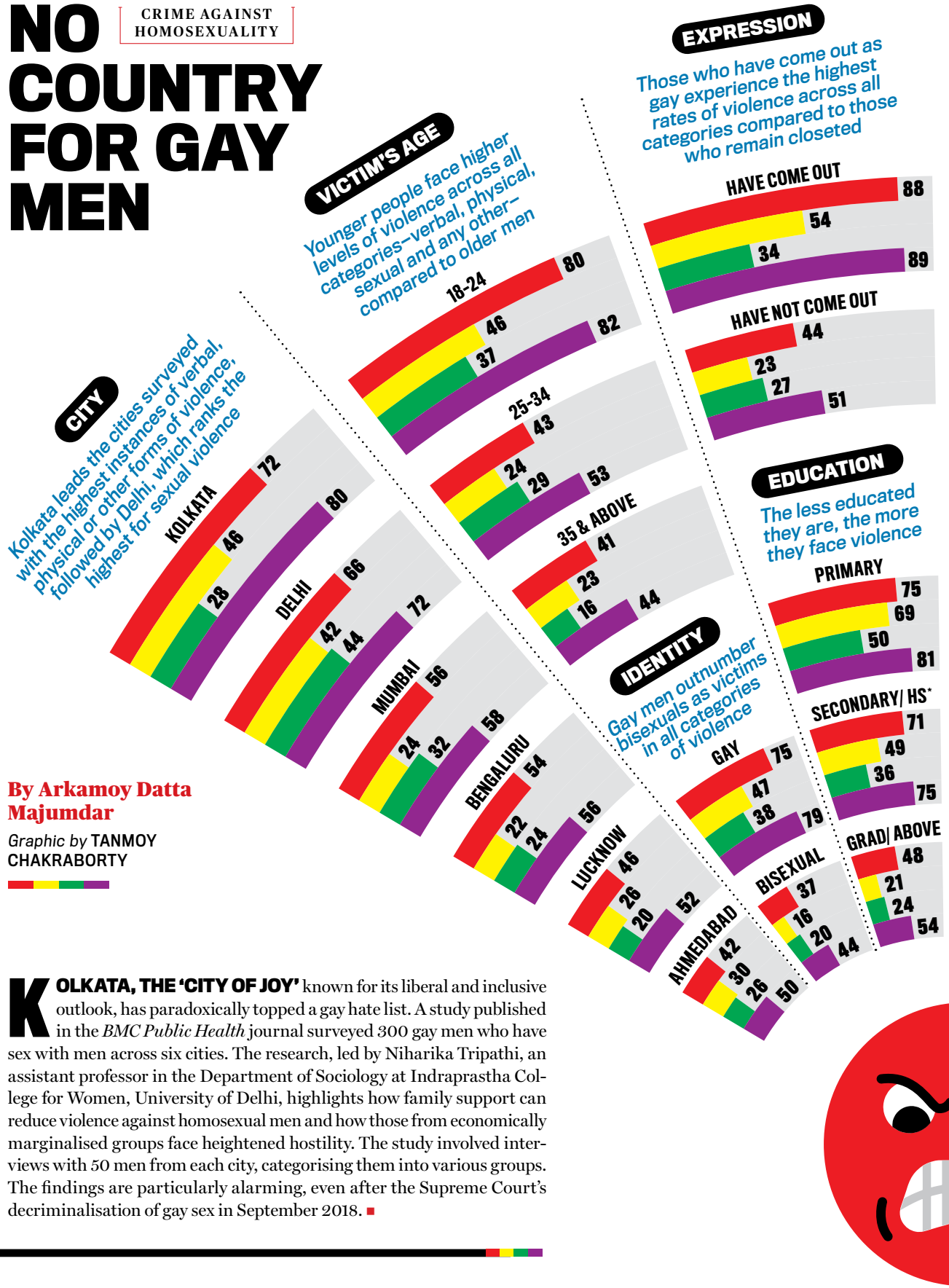
CRIME AGAINST HOMOSEXUALITY

NO COUNTRY FOR GAY MEN



By Arkamoy Datta Majumdar

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

KOLKATA, THE 'CITY OF JOY' known for its liberal and inclusive outlook, has paradoxically topped a gay hate list. A study published in the *BMC Public Health* journal surveyed 300 gay men who have sex with men across six cities. The research, led by Niharika Tripathi, an assistant professor in the Department of Sociology at Indraprastha College for Women, University of Delhi, highlights how family support can reduce violence against homosexual men and how those from economically marginalised groups face heightened hostility. The study involved interviews with 50 men from each city, categorising them into various groups. The findings are particularly alarming, even after the Supreme Court's decriminalisation of gay sex in September 2018. ■